

DARPA's \$130 million virtual battle field

DARPA intends to create a virtual battle field to help against cyber attacks

Microsoft takes on Google Docs

Office 365 is the answer from Microsoft to the challenges from Google Apps and Google Docs

Asus Rampage III Black Edition

An overclocker's dream come true

The Republic of Gamers series of boards from ASUS are meant for the enthusiast crowd who will indulge in a lot of overclocking of their high end Core i7 CPUs. In keeping with that tradition, the Rampage III Black Edition can be called the successor to the Rampage III Extreme. The matte-black body houses the high end X58 chipset and is packed to the gills with state of the art components such as solid state caps, intricately designed heat sinks, a whole range of ROG exclusive features (such as ROG Connect - for external overclocking via a laptop or iPad for example), an onboard Bluetooth and Wi-Fi adapter, the Thunderbolt combo card (which



houses Xonar sound component and Bigfoot Killer E2100 networking hardware), etc. Calling this board feature-rich is an understatement. We tested the board with an Intel Core i7 980X processor and an AMD HD6850 card. As expected it aced the tests. On stock

settings (Memory - 1333MHz and CPU - 3.3GHz) PCMark Vantage gave an overall score of 10,300, Cinebench R10 rendering gave a multi-core score of 22,842 marks, Video encoding (100 MB VOB to DIVX) took 22 secs whereas Crysis Warhead (1680x1050, med) gave 63 FPS. We overclocked the memory using the XMP profile 1 (Memory - 2,000MHz) and the board to 4.1 GHz - on air. The system ran fine without any blue screens, giving a 15-percent increase in some benchmarks.

The price of the board is enough to build an entry-level multimedia rig.

Nimish Sawant

Specifications

Socket: LGA 1366; **Chipset:** Intel X58 / ICH10R, up to 48 GB DDR3 RAM; **On-board:** Bluetooth 3.0 and WiFi adapter; Thunderbolt LAN/Audio; **Ports:** 2xUSB3.0, 7x USB2.0, 2x eSATA

Contact

ASUS Technology Pvt. Ltd.
Phone: 1800-209 0365
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Website: www.asus.in
Price: ₹39,500

8.5/10

Features 9.0
Performance 8.5
Build Quality 9.0
Value for Money 6.5

Acer Liquid Mini E310

Affordable FroYo phone; not for camera and audio junkies

Specifications

Bands: GSM 850 / 900 / 1800 / 1900 and HSDPA 900 / 2100; **OS:** Android 2.2; **Display size:** 3.2-inches; **Resolution:** 340x480 pixels; **Camera:** 5 MP; **Battery:** 1300 mAh.

Contact

Acer India Pvt Ltd
Phone: 91 80 3940 8700
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Price: ₹11,990

6.0/10

Features 7.0
Performance 5.5
Build Quality 5.5
Value for Money 7.5

Acer Liquid Mini E310 is a younger cousin of the higher end Acer Liquid.

Housing the Android 2.2 FroYo OS, it's upgradeable to 2.3, but we wonder how smooth the user interface would be with 600 MHz of processing power. Aesthetics are very similar to the Acer Liquid. We didn't like the cheap plastic cover and absence of flash above the 5 MP camera. As with the older Liquid phones, the Mini also has an overlaid Breeze UI

with slight modifications. The history module on the left hand side has a coverflow interface which continues on the right hand side with the media.

Call quality across all test zones was quite good with clear voice rendition and this was true of the handsfree as well. User interface is quite snappy. It comes with integrated social networking apps such as Facebook and Social Jogger - which integrates your Twitter and Facebook updates. The notification bar also has mul-

tiple home screens popping out from each icon, which is quite a good feature to have. The 5 MP camera is great for outdoor shots and has quite a few customisation options. Indoor shots are noisy. Video shooting is not good at all as there is prominent framing and visible changing of colour cast as you move your phone's camera. Sound quality is OK, but the volume levels are not that impressive. The bundled earphones provide no sound isolation, so you are better off not listening to music in traffic.

Acer Liquid Mini E310 is an affordable phone for its features and performance and ideal for someone looking at a feature rich phone.

Nimish Sawant

